

If answers of all the questions above is ‘yes’, you might be a suitable candidate for using the advanced partitioning tool. If, however, any answer is a ‘no’, we suggest you allow Ubuntu to take a wiser decision by selecting “Install Ubuntu alongside Windows 7”. Unless you’re in a mood to experiment with partitioning and understand the fact that a failed experiment might result in total loss of data with an unbootable fate, you should select the first option and let Ubuntu take decisions on its own. Even if all the answers for the questions above are ‘yes’ but you still get stuck at some error or message shown by Ubuntu during partitioning, you should select the first option (Install Ubuntu alongside Windows 7) to let Ubuntu decide the best option.

If you’re about to make the partitions yourself, do make sure that you allot about 1.5 to 3.0 times the installed RAM as swap area. Although lesser can also be used, allocating the swap area based on this calculation promises better performance.

Upon selection of the right choice and creating partitions, click on ‘Install now’ and installation will start straight away.

The rest of the steps are the same as for “Installing Ubuntu on a Machine with No OS”. We mention them here for an easy reference.

Step 4: Choose your timezone and click ‘Forward’.

Step 5: Select your keyboard layout.

Step 6: Enter your name, a username, password, machine name and choose autologin options.

Step 7: Wait while Ubuntu downloads the package list or skip the step and reboot the system after installation completes.

Upon following these steps, you’ll be able to boot into the Windows or Ubuntu by selecting one from the boot menu.

Staying safe during installation

In case you want to install Windows and Ubuntu from scratch, it’s best to clean the disk space by removing everything (back up to external disks or USB / DVD drives) and doing away with all partitions first. Then, create only one partition when installing Windows. This will allow you to have two more primary partitions later (Windows 7 setup creates and utilises